

# Dog Body Signals

What their body and mood are telling you



## Body condition, at a glance

### Too thin

Ribs/spine easily felt, no fat cover

### Ideal

Ribs felt with slight fat cover, visible waist

### Overweight

Ribs hard to feel, no visible waist

## Reading the signals

### Happy looks like

- ♥ A loose, full-body wag
- ♥ Relaxed, open mouth (a "doggy smile")
- ♥ Play bows (front down, rear end up)
- ♥ Soft, relaxed eyes and ears

### Stressed looks like

- ♥ A tucked tail or lowered body
- ♥ Yawning or lip-licking when not tired/hungry
- ♥ Whale eye (whites of the eyes showing)
- ♥ Excessive panting when not hot or active

## A few enrichment ideas

- ♥ A slow, sniffy walk with no destination lets them decompress through scent — often more tiring than a fast one
- ♥ A puzzle feeder or snuffle mat turns treat time into a satisfying mental workout
- ♥ A game of tug or fetch burns energy fast and strengthens your bond through play
- ♥ Rotating toys every week or two makes old favorites feel new and exciting again



# Dog Must-Knows



1

Puppies eat 3-4 small meals a day; adults do best with 2 meals at regular times

2

Never feed grapes/raisins (can cause sudden kidney failure) or xylitol (triggers a dangerous insulin spike)

3

Size a crate so they can stand, turn around, and lie down comfortably

4

Book a first vet check-up within the first week of coming home

5

A swollen, hard belly with unproductive retching is an emergency — seek care immediately

## Bonus fun fact

A dog's sense of smell is estimated to be 10,000 to 100,000 times more sensitive than a human's.

## Loved these? Maple has so much more.

The Dog Parent Guide, Sitter Kit & Journal go way deeper — checklists, trackers, keepsakes & more, made just for your dog.

[See the full collection at georgiekins.com](https://georgiekins.com)



# Dog Emergency & Prep

What to watch for, and how to get ready



## Call the vet if you see

- ♥ Not eating or drinking for 24 hours
- ♥ Repeated vomiting or diarrhea
- ♥ A swollen, hard belly with unproductive retching — seek care immediately
- ♥ Limping, excessive drinking/urinating, or sudden behavior changes
- ♥ Coughing, labored breathing, or crying when touched

## If something risky gets eaten

Call your vet or the ASPCA Animal Poison Control Center:  
**(888) 426-4435 — available 24/7**

